

The Great Fire of London 1666

No. 118

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

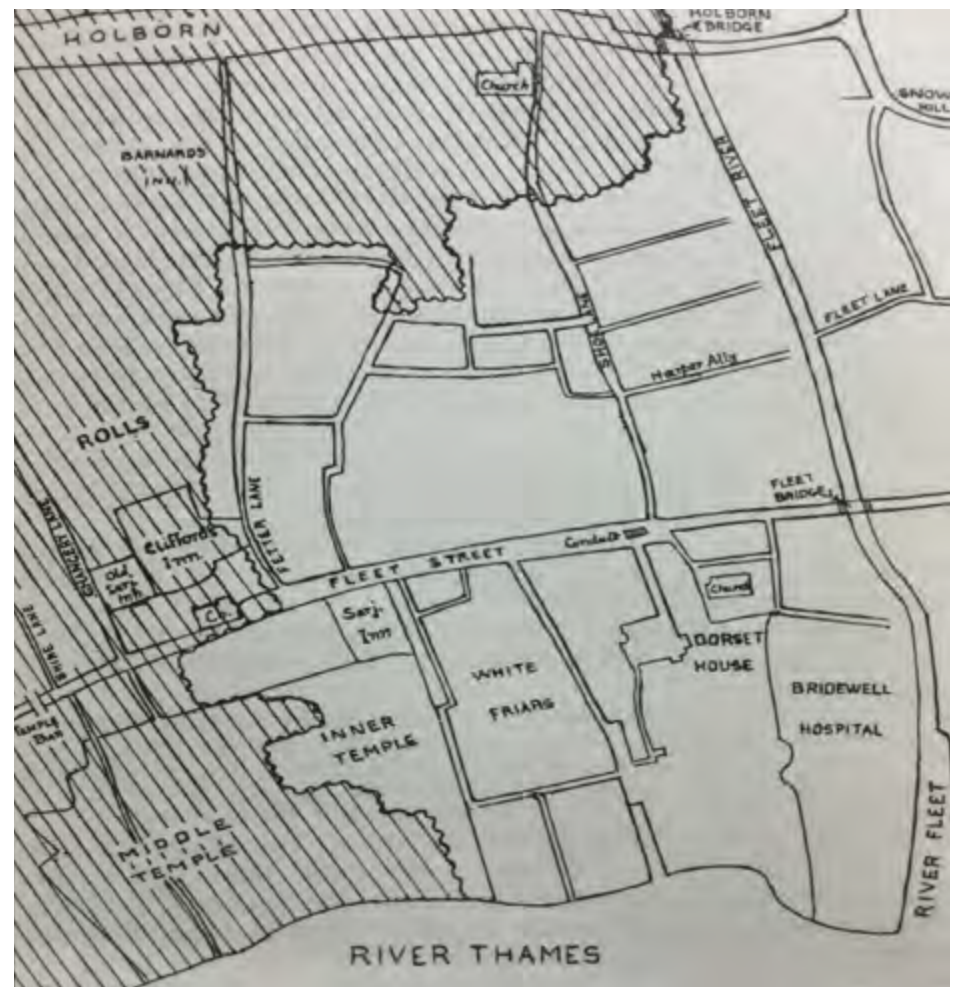
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In 1666, a bakery near the Monument caught fire. It was very hot and windy, so the fire spread fast. It burned for four days and destroyed most of London, including houses, churches, and buildings on Fleet Street and the Temple.

After the fire, people wanted to make wider streets, but there was not enough money. The King said new buildings had to be made of brick, not wood. People had to pay to rebuild their homes.

A special Fire Court with 22 judges was made to decide who had to rebuild. The court first met in February 1667 at Clifford's Inn, which was not destroyed.

The City thanked the judges by making big paintings of them for the Guildhall. Two of these paintings are still there today.



The Extent of the Great Fire of London (the hatched area escaped the Fire)



The Fire Table, at which the Fire Court Judges sat in Clifford's Inn



Sir Matthew Hale, one of the Fire Court Judges